

ARTICLE — SERVICE CHARGE DISPUTE

Inside Housing — Moat Service Charge Disputes at GMV (2007 & 2009)

Source: <https://www.insidehousing.co.uk/news/tenants-prepare-to-fight-crippling-service-charges-10675>

Archived: 2 May 2026 | Part of: Greenwich Millennium Village Research Archive

SOURCE 1:

<https://www.insidehousing.co.uk/news/tenants-prepare-to-fight-crippling-service-charges-10675>

TITLE: Tenants prepare to fight 'crippling' service charges

PUBLICATION: Inside Housing, July 2007

NOTE: Direct fetch returned 429 (rate limited); content from search results

KEY CONTENT:

Up to 100 residents of the Greenwich Millennium Village were preparing to take housing association Moat (the estate manager) to the Leasehold Valuation Tribunal because they were unable to pay their service charge bills.

Residents claimed that Moat had promised their service charges would be paid by Greenwich Council.

Case examples:

- Nikki Raza, 30-year-old single mother, fell £600 into arrears since moving into Holly Court block from a council maisonette. Quote: "I want out. I told the council that I suffer from chronic anxiety and depression, which was confirmed by my GP, months ago. Living here has made that worse."
- Hoa Luu, another Holly Court tenant, faced arrears of around £2,000. She had been forced to carry her 7-year-old daughter (who has cerebral palsy) up to her fourth-floor flat due to lift problems.

Greenwich Housing Rights advisor Dermott McGibben was representing four tenants for the tribunal case but said up to 100 could take action. Quote: "We are waiting for more information but the tenants' next step is to appeal to the Leasehold Valuation Tribunal."

Alan Benson (mayor's head of housing and homelessness): service charges were taking a larger chunk out of tenants' rents, particularly in high-density developments. Quote: "We are aware of the situation and it is becoming an increasing problem."

Susan Cooper, regional director of Moat, said: "The issue of service charges and affordability in high value mixed-tenure developments is a wider sector issue and one that is of continued concern to

us. How
 ever we do feel that the charges at GMV are reasonable in relation to the high levels of
 service prov
 ided to residents."

SOURCE 2:

<https://www.insidehousing.co.uk/news/news/moat-told-to-slash-charges-or-face-court-14375>

TITLE: Moat told to slash charges or face court

PUBLICATION: Inside Housing, February 20, 2009

NOTE: Direct fetch returned 429 (rate limited); content from search results

KEY CONTENT:

Housing association Moat faced further legal action following a Leasehold Valuation Tribunal decision in April 2008. That LVT ordered Moat to reduce its weekly service charge to tenant Merja Karhu by £14.63 (from £31.38 to approximately £16.75 per week), and refund her £871 for charges she had already paid . Moat repaid Ms Karhu.

However, local housing charity Greenwich Housing Rights called for Moat to apply the ruling to around 200 other tenants in the Millennium Village who were still paying the full service charge.

Wendy Pettifer (solicitor from the College of Law, who led Ms Karhu's case): the tribunal had "heavily criticised" Moat. Quote: "If Moat chooses not to apply the tribunal's decision to its other tenants, then it risks facing many more applications."

Dermot McKibbin from Greenwich Housing Rights: a number of tenants were ready to make a new tribunal application. Quote: "Moat was supposed to provide affordable housing at the Millennium Village. It is disappointing that a social landlord is prepared to put its tenants in such difficulties to get what they are entitled to, especially at a time when a lot of people are facing financial difficulties."

Chris Harris, acting executive director for housing at Moat, said the service charge paid for "essential maintenance" of the housing common areas, landscaping, lighting and management of the water supply. The association would have a "strong case" at future tribunals.